UNIT 2 – STORY TELLING

1. **Storytelling Techniques in Video Editing**

Introduction

Storytelling in video production means presenting events, characters, and emotions in a clear and interesting way so that the audience can understand and feel the story.
Editing plays a major role in storytelling because it decides:

- what shots are shown,
- in what order,
- for how long,
- and how scenes move from one to another.

Good storytelling techniques make a video engaging, logical, emotional, and memorable.

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1) Narrative Structure

Most videos follow a simple three-part structure.

Parts

- **Beginning (Setup)**
  Introduces characters, place, and problem.
- **Middle (Conflict/Development)**
  Events grow, tension increases, story moves forward.
- **End (Resolution)**
  Problem is solved, story finishes.
- Helps audience follow easily
- Creates emotional satisfaction

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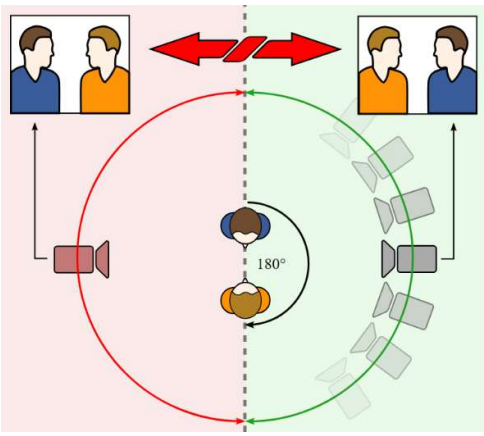
2) Continuity Editing

Continuity editing means arranging shots so that the action looks smooth and natural, without confusing the viewer.

- Maintain screen direction.
- Keep consistent lighting and costume.
- Match actions between shots.
- Follow the 180-degree rule.
- Makes scenes Realistic



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3) Use of Different Shot Types

Different camera shots help tell the story emotionally.

Common Shots

- **Wide shot** – shows place and environment.
- **Medium shot** – shows interaction.
- **Close-up** – shows emotions.
- **Over-the-shoulder** – shows conversations.
- **Cutaway** – shows related detail.

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4) Pacing and Rhythm

Pacing means how fast or slow a scene moves.

Fast Pacing

- Short shots & Quick cuts.
- Used in action scenes.

Slow Pacing

- Long shots.
- Fewer cuts.
- Used in emotional or dramatic scenes.

Effect on Audience

- Creates excitement.
- Builds tension.
- Gives time to feel emotions.

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5) Montage Technique

A montage is a series of short shots edited together to show:

- passage of time,
- training or growth,
- travel,
- repeated actions.

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6) Sound as a Storytelling Tool

Sound strongly supports visuals.

Types

- Dialogue
- Background music
- Sound effects
- Silence

Uses

- Sets mood.
- Creates tension.
- Shows location.
- Connects scenes.
- Makes emotions stronger.

Storyboard in Digital Video Editing

Storyboard in Digital Video Editing

A storyboard is a visual planning tool used before shooting and editing a video. It is made up of a sequence of drawings or frames that show how each shot will appear on screen. Along with sketches, notes are written about camera movement, dialogue, sound effects, and transitions.

In digital video editing, storyboards help editors and directors clearly understand:

- what shots are needed,
- how scenes will be arranged,
- how the story flows visually.

What is a Storyboard?

A storyboard is like a **comic strip for a video**.

Each contains:

- a simple sketch of the shot,
- camera angle or movement,
- dialogue or narration,
- sound effects or music,
- duration of the shot,
- type of transition.

It shows the plan of the entire video before actual shooting or editing begins.

Why Storyboards are Important in Digital Editing

Storyboards play a major role in both production and post-production.

Main Purposes

- Helps visualize the final video
- Guides camera operators during shooting.
- Makes editing easier later.

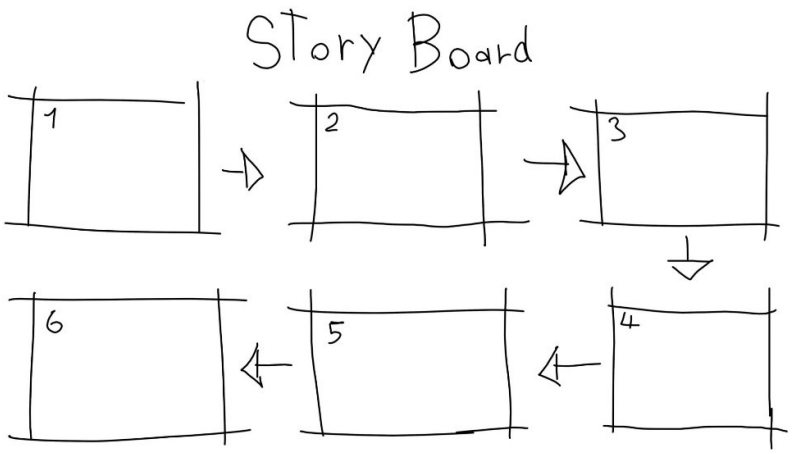
- Avoids unnecessary shots.
- Saves production cost and time.
- Improves communication among team members.

Types of Storyboards

Storyboards can be prepared in different ways.

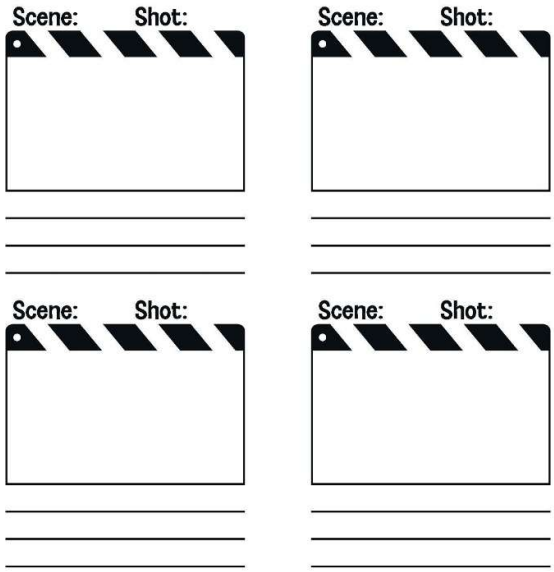
1) Hand-Drawn Storyboards

- Simple sketches on paper.
- Used in classrooms and low-budget projects.
- Focus on idea rather than art quality.



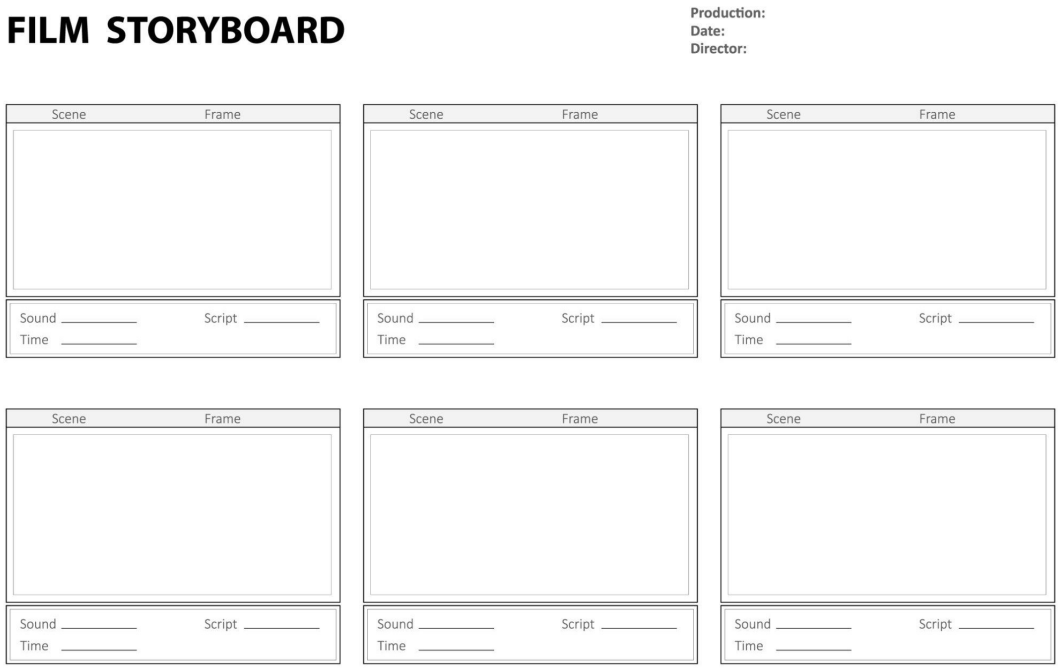
2) Digital Storyboards

- Created using software or tablets.
- Easy to modify.
- Can include colour and annotations.



3) Photographic Storyboards

- Use photos instead of drawings.
- Quick for live-action planning.



Steps to Create a Storyboard

Step-by-step process:

1. Read the script or story idea carefully.
2. Break the story into scenes and shots.
3. Decide important actions in each shot.
4. Sketch each frame roughly.
5. Write camera angles and movements.
6. Add sound or dialogue notes.
7. Mark shot duration.
8. Decide transitions between shots.
9. Review and revise the storyboard.

How Storyboards Help Storytelling

Storyboards improve storytelling by:

- keeping a clear beginning, middle, and end,
- maintaining continuity,
- planning emotional moments,
- deciding where close-ups are needed,
- controlling pacing,
- avoiding confusion.

Advantages of Using Storyboards

- Clear visual plan.
- Saves editing time.
- Reduces mistakes.
- Improves teamwork.
- Keeps production organised.
- Helps budget control.
- Useful for complex scenes.
- Improves story clarity.

Introduction

A **cut** is the most basic and commonly used transition in video editing. It is the point where one shot ends and the next shot begins immediately, without any fade or dissolve.

Cuts are extremely important in storytelling because they:

- decide the speed of a scene,
- change camera angles,
- control emotions,
- increase tension or calmness,
- maintain continuity.
- move the story forward,
- switch locations,
- remove unwanted portions,

Editors choose different kinds of cuts depending on the mood, story need, and visual flow.

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1) Straight Cut (Simple Cut)

Meaning

- A straight cut is a direct change from one shot to another. Used for Conversations, Aciton scenes, Scene Continuation

Features

- No visual effect.
- Instant switch.
- Most natural-looking transition.
- Used in almost every scene.
- Showing reactions.

2) Jump Cut

A jump cut happens when two shots of the same subject are placed next to each other, but with a noticeable change in position or time. This makes the subject appear to "jump" suddenly.

Purpose

- Show passage of time quickly.
- Speed up boring sections.
- Create nervous or energetic feeling.
- Stylised effect in vlogs or music videos.

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3) Match Cut (Match on Action / Graphic Match)

A match cut connects two shots using similar action, shape, or movement so that the transition feels smooth.

- Maintain continuity.
- Smooth scene change.
- Keep realism.
- Visual creativity.

4) Reaction Cut

Meaning

A reaction cut shows how another person reacts to an event.

Uses

- Show emotion.
- Build drama.
- Guide audience feeling.

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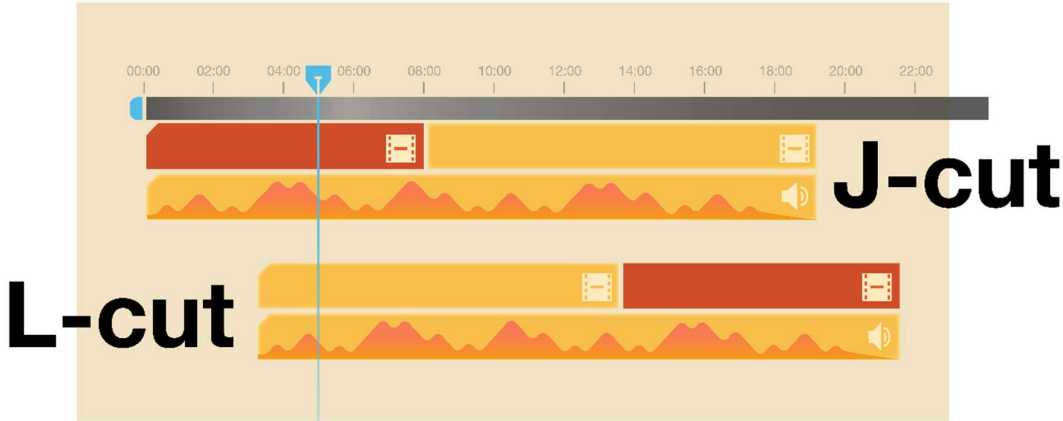
5) L-Cut and J-Cut (Split Edits)

These are audio-based cuts.

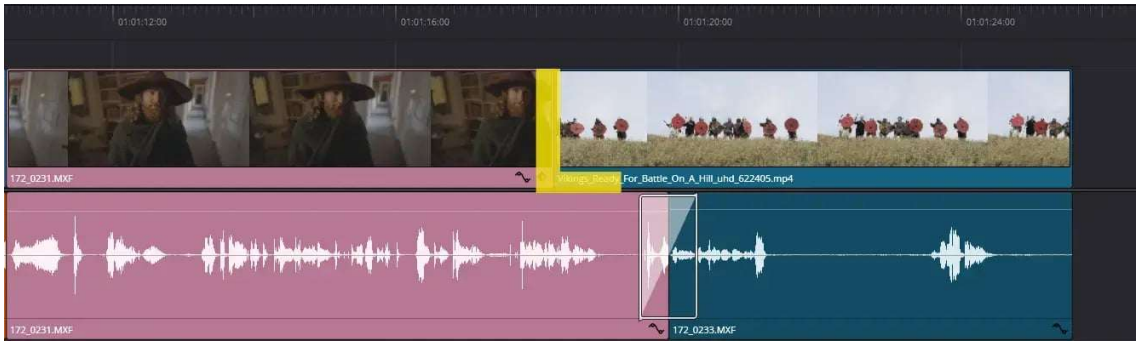
L-Cut

- Audio from first shot continues into the next shot.
- Video changes first.



J-Cut

- Audio from next shot starts before the picture changes.



Uses

- Smooth transitions.
- Natural conversations.
- Scene linking.
- Professional flow.

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6) Cross-Cutting / Parallel Cutting

Cross-cutting switches between two different actions happening at the same time in different places.

Uses

- Build suspense.
- Show connection.
- Compare situations.
- Race-against-time scenes.

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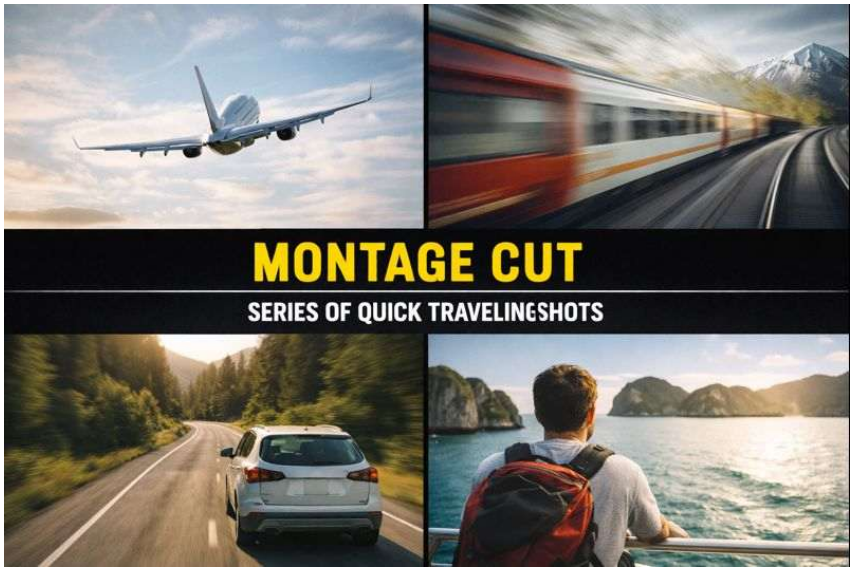
7) Montage Cutting

Meaning

Many short shots are cut together quickly to show time passing or development.

Uses

- Training scenes.
- Travel.
- Growth of character.
- Repeated activities.